

[Company Name]

[Company Name] — [One-Line Description]

"[Company Name] is a [product type] that helps [target customer] [achieve
[achieve specific outcome]]."

[Presenter Name(s)]

[Date]

[Target Customer] loses [X hours / \$Y] every [time period] because [root cause]

The Core Problem

State the problem in one clear sentence.
Make it visceral and specific to your target customer.

Quantifying the Pain

- Time lost per week/month
- Money wasted on inefficient processes
- Risk incurred by the business

Why the Status Quo Fails

Explain why existing solutions are broken. E.g., manual work, error-prone spreadsheets, or disjointed vendors with no unified view.



Real quote from a real customer describing the pain in their own words. Keep typos and informal language — it signals authenticity.

[Customer Name]

[Role], [Company Name]

[Company Name] [does specific thing] so that [customer] can [achieve outcome] without [pain/friction]

What It Is

[Product type and category]

How It Works

1. [Step 1: User action]
2. [Step 2: System response]
3. [Step 3: Outcome achieved]

The Outcome

[Concrete, measurable outcome and primary benefit delivered to the customer]

[Product Name] in action — [3-step workflow]

01

[User Action]

Describe the initial action the user takes. Keep it simple and focused on ease of use (e.g., "Connect your accounting software in 30 seconds").

02

[System Response]

Explain what the product does automatically in the background (e.g., "Platform auto-generates monthly VAT and CIT filings").

03

[Outcome Achieved]

Highlight the final result and concrete benefit (e.g., "Review and submit with one click — done in under 20 minutes").

[Key metric] growing [X%] month-over-month — [N] paying customers in [timeframe]

CURRENT MRR

\$28,000

Up from \$0 eight months ago

PAYING CUSTOMERS

47

Across 6 countries

RETENTION

118%

Net Revenue Retention (0% churn)

Revenue Growth (MRR)

Unit economics confirm a scalable, high-margin business

AVERAGE CONTRACT VALUE (ACV)

\$7,200/yr

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST (CAC)

\$1,100

LTV:CAC RATIO

19.6x

GROSS MARGIN

74%

LIFETIME VALUE (LTV)

\$21,600

PAYBACK PERIOD

6 months

Our insight: [Non-obvious thing you know that others don't]

The Core Insight

State the non-obvious truth that makes your approach work. Explain exactly what you understand about the customer or market that others have missed.

How We Know It

Detail how this insight was derived. Was it through hundreds of customer interviews, deep personal industry experience, or proprietary data analysis?

The Unfair Advantage

Explain why incumbents cannot easily replicate this and why it creates a durable, long-term competitive moat for your business.

[Revenue model]: [Price point] per [unit], targeting [customer segment], with [gross margin]% gross margin

Revenue Streams

PRIMARY

[e.g., SaaS subscription per legal entity]

SECONDARY

[e.g., Professional services for complex filings]

Target & Pricing

TARGET SEGMENT

[e.g., SMEs and mid-market foreign-invested
invested enterprises]

PRICE POINT

[e.g., \$599/month per entity]

Economics

GROSS MARGIN

[74]%

BLENDED MARGIN

[42]%

A \$[X]B addressable market, growing at [Y]% annually — and we are entering at the fastest-growing segment

TAM

TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET

\$4.3^B

Bottom-up: 1.2M targets × \$3,600/yr

SAM

SERVICEABLE ADDRESSABLE MARKET

\$648^M

Reach: 180k SME customers seeking solutions

SOM

SERVICEABLE OBTAINABLE MARKET

\$32^M

5-year target: 5% market share

Source: [Industry Registry 2024]; [Major Consulting Firm Market Report 2023]

We are the only solution that combines [X] and [Y] — the two things customers care most about

Competitive Landscape



Key Differentiators

1. The only platform built natively for for [specific environment] in [specific [specific languages].
2. Direct API integration with [key system] system] — eliminating manual data entry entirely.
3. [X]-hour onboarding process versus [Y] [Y] weeks for traditional alternatives.

Three converging forces make this the right moment — and a 24-month window before it closes

Regulatory Shift

MANDATORY COMPLIANCE

Recent amendments to local data and compliance laws require all foreign-invested enterprises to appoint local officers and file digitally.

Creates an immediate, mandatory need for 180,000+ companies.

Technology Shift

AI & AUTOMATION

GPT-4-class models now translate and interpret complex regulatory text with >94% accuracy, making automated compliance viable.

Reduces processing cost to <\$0.01 per document.

Market Shift

INCUMBENT PRICING

Legacy players (Big 4 accounting firms) have raised SME compliance retainers by 40% since 2022, reducing coverage for smaller firms.

Pushes 60,000+ companies to seek digital alternatives.

A compounding go-to-market loop: land with [initial product], expand across the entity's full operations

Land

ACQUISITION

Acquire target customers through high-high-trust channels.

- [e.g., Incubator partnerships]
- [e.g., Chamber of commerce events]

Expand

UPSELL & CROSS-SELL

Once onboarded for the initial use case, case, seamlessly introduce additional additional modules.

- [e.g., Payroll processing]
- [e.g., Corporate banking integration]

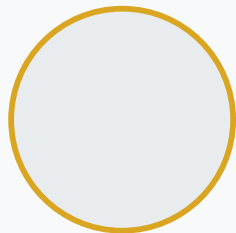
Loop

REFERRAL & ORGANIC GROWTH

Leverage success to attract the next cohort of customers organically.

- Satisfied customers refer others in their network
- Maintain NPS > 60 to drive word-of-mouth

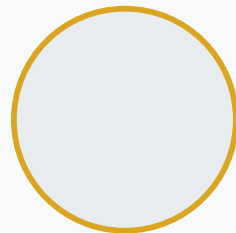
The team most qualified to solve this problem — [X] years of combined experience in [domain]



[Founder 1 Name]

CEO

- Former Head of Compliance, [Major Bank] ([X] years).
- Led the digitization of cross-border reporting for 3,000+ corporate clients.
- Native Mandarin speaker.



[Founder 2 Name]

CTO

- Previously Staff Engineer at [Major Tech Firm].
- Built regulatory reporting infrastructure processing ¥2T in annual transactions.
- MS Computer Science, Tsinghua University.

[10-word vision statement describing the world you are building toward]

The Future State

WHY IT MATTERS

We are building the operating system for [target market] — a single platform that handles [key functions] so that founders can focus entirely on building their product and growing their business.

The Scale of Impact:

If we succeed, we will have removed the single biggest operational barrier to barrier to [target outcome] in [market size/context].

Raising \$[X]M to reach \$[Y]K MRR and [Z] customers by [date]

The Raise

SEED ROUND

\$1.5M

Instrument

SAFE (Post-Money)

Runway

18–24 months

Use of Funds

CAPITAL ALLOCATION

45%

Product & Engineering
Engineering
Sales & Marketing

30%

15%

Operations & Legal

10%

Reserve

Milestones

SERIES A READINESS

With \$1.5M, we will:

- Reach \$50K MRR within 12 months (from (from current \$28K)
- Onboard 150 paying customers (from current 47)
- Achieve Series A readiness by Q4 2026

A path to \$[X]M ARR by [Year] — driven by [primary growth lever]

3-Year Projections

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Customers	150	420	980
ARR	\$1.08M	\$3.02M	\$7.06M
Gross Margin	72%	75%	78%
Burn Rate	\$95K/mo	\$140K/mo	\$180K/mo
Runway (post-raise)	18 months	—	—

Key Assumptions

- **Growth:** 63% MoM growth rate maintained for 6 months, declining to 12% by Month 18.
- **ACV:** Average ACV of \$7,200 (current average: \$7,140).
- **Retention:** Churn of 1.5% (current: 0%).
- **Acquisition:** 100, payback period of 6 months.

Let's build together

The Vision

*"Every foreign founder
should be able to build in
China without
bureaucratic friction."*

Contact Us

FOUNDER & CEO

[Founder Name]

EMAIL

ceo@[company].com

WEBSITE

www.[company].com

Book a Meeting



SCAN TO SCHEDULE

calendly.com/[company]-investor
investor

Appendix: Founder Guidelines

Critical "Not-To-Dos" and pitch best practices based on insights from Y Combinator
Combinator partners.

Not-To-Do: Core Messaging & Problem Framing

The Pitfalls (Don't Do This)

USING DENSE JARGON

"We are a synergistic, blockchain-blockchain-enabled paradigm shift." Investors tune out immediately when they hear buzzwords instead of a clear business description.

INVENTING THE PROBLEM

Spending three slides trying to convince the investor that a problem exists. If it requires that much explanation, it's probably not a real, acute pain point.

PITCHING A "PLATFORM" ON DAY ONE

Claiming you will build an all-encompassing ecosystem right away. This signals a dangerous lack of focus to early-stage investors.

Best Practices (Do This Instead)

THE "14-YEAR-OLD" TEST

Explain what you do so simply that a that a smart 14-year-old could understand it. State exactly what the what the product is and who it is for is for by Slide 2.

TARGET OBVIOUS, FREQUENT PAIN PAIN

The best problems are obvious and and painful. State the problem in one in one sentence. If the investor nods immediately, move straight to straight to your solution.

SOLVE ONE THING EXCEPTIONALLY WELL

Startups win by solving one specific, acute problem better than anyone else. anyone else. Pitch the "wedge" product first, then briefly explain how it how it expands later.

Not-To-Do: Market Sizing, Traction & Numbers

Market Sizing

DON'T

Rely exclusively on top-down TAM calculations (e.g., "The logistics market is \$1T, if we just get 1%..."). Don't say you have "no competition."

DO

Use a bottom-up calculation (Number of reachable customers $\times$ Price). Acknowledge that the status quo (Excel, manual labor) is your primary competition.

Traction Metrics

DON'T

Use cumulative charts that always go up and to the right, masking business health. Don't rely on vanity metrics like total registered users or users or app downloads.

DO

Show active, periodic growth metrics (e.g., MoM MoM MRR growth, Weekly Active Users, Retention Retention rates). Investors care about active usage and revenue.

Financial Projections

DON'T

Project unrealistic "hockey-stick" growth without explanation. If revenue is flat now and spikes next year, an unexplained inflection point is a red flag.

DO

Detail the specific, credible mechanism or go-to-go-to-market strategy that will cause growth. Ensure unit economics (CAC, LTV) support the scaling model.

Not-To-Do: Team, The Ask & Delivery

The Team

DON'T

Highlight advisors as core team members to compensate for gaps. Over-emphasizing advisors makes the actual founding team look weak.

DO

Focus entirely on the full-time founders. Highlight specific domain expertise and past execution ability that proves you are the right people to build this.

The Ask

DON'T

Be vague about the raise (e.g., "We are raising \$1M raising \$1M to \$2M"). Don't ask for money without without explaining exactly what it buys the investor.

DO

State a specific target amount, the instrument (SAFE/Priced), and the exact milestones it unlocks (e.g., "Gets us to \$50k MRR MRR and Series A readiness").

Pitch Delivery

DON'T

Deliver a 15-minute monologue, cram paragraphs of text onto slides, or get defensive when investors ask tough questions or point out flaws.

DO

Keep the pitch to 5-7 minutes. Use large fonts. fonts. View Q&A as a test of how you think, not an not an attack. Acknowledge valid points calmly. calmly.